

अथ षष्ठोऽध्यायः

ऋषिरुवाच ॥ १ ॥

इत्याकर्ण्य वचो देव्याः स दूतोऽमर्षपूरितः ।
समाचष्ट समागम्य दैत्यराजाय विस्तरात् ॥ २ ॥

तस्य दूतस्य तद्वाक्यमाकर्ण्यासुरराट् ततः ।
सक्रोधः ग्राह दैत्यानामधिपं धूम्रलोचनम् ॥ ३ ॥

हे धूम्रलोचनाशु त्वं स्वसैन्यपरिवारितः ।
तामानय बलाद्दुष्टां केशाकर्षणविह्वलाम् ॥ ४ ॥

1-2. The Rṣi said: The messenger, filled with indignation on hearing the words of the Devī, returned and related them in detail to the king of the daityas.

3-4. Then the asura monarch, enraged on hearing that report from his messenger, told Dhūmrālocana, a chieftain of the daityas: 'O Dhūmrālocana, hasten together with your army and fetch here by force that shrew, distressed when dragged by her hair.

तत्परित्राणदः कश्चिद्यदि वोत्तिष्ठतेऽपरः ।

स हन्तव्योऽमरो वापि यक्षो गन्धर्व एव वा ॥ ५ ॥

ऋषिरुवाच ॥ ६ ॥

तेनाज्ञप्तस्ततः शीघ्रं स दैत्यो धूम्रलोचनः ।

वृत्तः षष्ट्या सहस्राणामसुराणां द्रुतं ययौ ॥ ७ ॥

स दृष्ट्वा तां ततो देवीं तुहिनाचलसंस्थिताम् ।

जगादोच्चैः प्रयाहीति मूलं शुम्भनिशुम्भयोः ॥ ८ ॥

न चेत्प्रीत्याद्य भवती मद्भर्तारमुपैष्यति ।

ततो बलान्नयाम्येष केशकर्षणविह्वलाम् ॥ ९ ॥

5. 'Or if any one else stands up as her saviour, let him be slain, be he a god, a yakṣa or a gandharva.'

6-7. The Ṛṣi said: Then the asura Dhūmrālocana, commanded thus by Śumbha, went forth quickly, accompanied by sixty thousand asuras.

8. On seeing the Devī seated on the snowy mountain, he asked her aloud, 'Come to the presence of Śumbha and Niśumbha.'

9. 'If you will not go to my lord with pleasure now, here I take you by force, distressed when dragged from your hair.'

देव्युवाच ॥ १० ॥

दैत्येश्वरेण प्रहितो बलवान्बलसंवृतः ।

बलान्नयसि मामेवं ततः किं ते करोम्यहम् ॥ ११ ॥

ऋषिरुवाच ॥ १२ ॥

इत्युक्तः सोऽभ्यधावत्तामसुरो धूम्रलोचनः ।

हुङ्कारेणैव तं भस्म सा चकाराम्बिका ततः ॥ १३ ॥

अथ क्रुद्धं महासैन्यमसुराणां तथाम्बिकाम् ।

ववर्ष सायकैस्तीक्ष्णैस्तथा शक्तिपरश्वधैः ॥ १४ ॥

10-11. The Devī said: You are sent by the lord of the asuras, mighty yourself and accompanied by an army. If you thus take me by force, then what can I do to you?

12-13. The Rṣi said: Thus told, the asura Dhūmrālocana rushed towards her and thereupon Ambikā reduced him to ashes with a mere heave of the sound 'hum'.¹

14. Then the great army of asuras became enraged and showered on Ambikā sharp arrows, javelins, and axes.

1. Huṁkāra is the utterance of the sound 'Hum' with which one shows contempt or anger.

ततो धुतसटः कोपात्कृत्वा नादं सुभैरवम् ।

पपातासुरसेनायां सिंहो देव्याः स्ववाहनः ॥ १५ ॥

कांश्चित्करप्रहारेण दैत्यानास्येन चापरान् ।

आक्रान्त्या चाधरेणान्यान् स जघान महासुरान् ॥ १६ ॥

केषाञ्चित्पाटयामास नखैः कोष्ठानि केसरी ।

तथा तलप्रहारेण शिरांसि कृतवान्पृथक् ॥ १७ ॥

विच्छिन्नबाहुशिरसः कृतास्तेन तथा परे ।

पपौ च रुधिरं कोष्ठादन्येषां धुतकेसरः ॥ १८ ॥

15. Then the lion, vehicle of the Devī, shaking its mane in anger, and making the most terrific roar, fell on the army of the asuras.

16. Some asuras, it slaughtered with a blow of its fore paw, others with its mouth, and other great asuras, by treading over with its hind legs.

17. The lion, with its claws, tore out the heart of some and severed heads with a blow of the paw.

18. And it severed arms and heads from others, and shaking its mane drank the blood from the hearts of others.

क्षणेन तद्वलं सर्वं क्षयं नीतं महात्मना ।
तेन केसरिणा देव्या वाहनेनातिकोपिना ॥ १९ ॥

श्रुत्वा तमसुरं देव्या निहतं धूम्रलोचनम् ।
बलं च क्षयितं कृत्स्नं देवीकेसरिणा ततः ॥ २० ॥

चुकोप दैत्याधिपतिः शुम्भः प्रस्फुरिताधरः ।
आज्ञापयामास च तौ चण्डमुण्डौ महासुरौ ॥ २१ ॥

हे चण्ड हे मुण्ड बलैर्बहुलैः परिवारितौ ।
तत्र गच्छतं गत्वा च सा समानीयतां लघु ॥ २२ ॥

केशेष्वकृष्य बद्ध्वा वा यदि वः संशयो युधि ।
तदाशेषायुधैः सर्वैरसुरैर्विनिहन्यताम् ॥ २३ ॥

19. In a moment all that army was destroyed by that high-spirited and exceedingly enraged lion who bore the Devī.

20-21. When S'umbha, the lord of Asuras, heard that asura Dhūmrālocana was slain by the Devī and all his army was destroyed by the lion of the Devī, he was infuriated, his lip quivered and he commanded the two mighty asuras Caṇḍa and Muṇḍa :

22-23. 'O Caṇḍa, O Muṇḍa, go there with large forces, and bring her here speedily, dragging her by

तस्यां हतायां दुष्टायां सिंहे च विनिपातिते ।
शीघ्रमागम्यतां बद्ध्वा गृहीत्वा तामथाम्बिकाम् ॥ २४ ॥

इति श्रीमार्कण्डेयपुराणे सावर्णिके मन्वन्तरे देवीमाहात्म्ये
धूम्रलोचनवधो नाम षष्ठोऽध्यायः ॥ ६ ॥

her hair or binding her. But if you have any doubt about doing that, then let the asures strike (her) in the fight with all their weapons.

24. 'When that shrew is wounded and her lion stricken down, seize that Ambikā, bind her and bring here quickly.'

Here ends the sixth chapter called 'The Slaying of Dhūmrālocana' of Devī-māhātmya in Mārkaṇḍeyapurāṇa during the period of Sāvarni, the Manu.

